

pursuing simplicity over just getting rid of stuff or obsessing over a lifestyle. You can have stuff and still have a simple life. You just have to define what that looks like for you.

Schedules

Once we've simplified and refined our physical space, we also need to look at our schedules and be honest about what's working and what's not. One of the biggest mishaps in our language is the term "time management." We can't manage time, we can only manage ourselves in the midst of time. Maybe it's just semantics, but we pack our schedules and to-do lists as if the term is taken literally.

Yet when we can effectively manage ourselves and our schedules, we reap the rewards of:

Time for ourselves. When it comes to self-care, we can struggle with feelings of selfishness or lack of deservingness, but the reality is we can only be the best version of ourselves for others when we've had space to meet our own needs. Whether it's taking a nap, gratitude journaling, participating in a hobby, or exercising creativity, it's carving out space in our schedules for these things that are life-giving and help us to show up for others as our best selves.

Richer connection. When we're not bogged down, busy, or distracted, our time with our loved ones can be more meaningful. When there's less to worry about or activities cluttering our calendar, we can enjoy the present moment and more fully engage with those around us.

Better health. There is plenty of research⁴ suggesting that reducing stress can lead to improved health. Stress can be the catalyst for autoimmune issues, colds, and even migraines. When we're not trying to multitask constantly or overcommitting our time, we can have more opportunities to breathe deeply, move around, eat better, and play, which decreases the negative effects of hypervigilance, tension, and consistent chemical spikes in our bodies.

Despite these benefits of a simpler schedule, we can still struggle with the *how*. A few of our favorite ways of putting this into practice include:

Learning to say no: Especially for my people pleasers, this is a difficult one to read. But we believe that what's kind and loving for you is *also*